recommendations of the Agranat Commission, that an external, professional, and extrajudicial body examine MI's intelligence products, as well as those of the Mossad and Shin Bet, following the establishment of their research bodies, in accordance with the recommendations of the Agranat Commission. Every attempt since the commission to establish a National Security Council, a national security adviser, an intelligence adviser, and so forth, amounted to a failed attempt that did not rise to the tasks as I defined them.

I will touch upon only one of these attempts, which I took part in, and which to the best of my knowledge has not been made public so far. The Agranat Commission completed its work and the State of Israel descended into a political spiral, as well as into a national trauma. Head of Military Intelligence Major General Eli Zeira resigned, as was recommended by the Agranat Commission, and was replaced by Major General Shlomo Gazit, a protégé of Moshe Dayan. IDF chief of staff David Elazar ("Dado") also resigned as per the commission's recommendation and with pressure from Dayan was replaced by General Motta Gur, who had been the IDF attaché in Washington during the war.

Defense Minister Dayan resigned, for the most part in the wake of public pressure. Prime Minister Golda Meir also resigned because of public pressure, but I think that in her case the deterioration in her health and her overwhelming stress and feelings of regret also contributed to her departure.

The door was open for Pinchas Sapir to become prime minister. The "professional politicians" of Mapai, of whom Sapir was one, wanted him in, but Sapir himself did not want the post. He believed that Israeli prime ministers should have a security orientation, and he did not feel that he fit the bill, especially after a war that had left the Israeli public wounded and questioning Israel's ability to continue to face its security challenges.

Yigal Allon, commander of the Palmach and perhaps the most prominent combat commander of the War of Independence, considered himself a natural candidate for prime minister, but Allon's political power was already depleted. As a member of the Ahdut Ha'avoda Party, which Mapai veterans had always viewed with suspicion, he knew that there was no chance that the majority of the Labor Party, who belonged to Mapai, would accept him as Golda's heir.

This situation led to Sapir, along with most of the Mapai oldtimers, choosing Yitzhak Rabin as Golda's successor. Rabin wanted the job, but in